A-A-50652
4 March 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

LIFE PRESERVER, VEST, ADULT OR CHILD (35-POUND BUOYANCY)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to MIL-L-38200.

Scope. This commercial item description covers a life preserver.

Applicable documents. The following documents are referenced in this commercial item description.

MIL-C-601	Cylinders, Carbon Dioxide Filled, Technical
MIL-F-10884	Fasteners, Snap
MIL-C-83489	Cloth; Coated, Nylon, Polyurethane Coated

(Copies of these military specifications can be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FED-STD-751 Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

(Copies of this Federal standard can be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Federal Aviation Regulations

(Copies of these regulations can be obtained from the Department of Transportation; Federal Aviation Administration; Washington, D. C. 20591.)

ATA Specification 801, 1 July 1958, "Airline Life Jackets"

(Copies of this specification can be obtained from the Air Transport Association of America; 1709 New York Ave., N. W.; Washington, D. C. 20006.)

Materials. Except for the coated fabrics, the materials that are used for the life preserver shall comply with ATA Specification 801. The coated fabrics that are used for the life preserver, including the flotation chambers and the storage container, shall conform to type I of MIL-C-83489 except that the minimum tearing strength of the coated cloth shall be 4.5 pounds in the warp direction and 3.5 pounds in the filling direction. The color of the coated fabrics shall be Spanish yellow in accordance with ATA Specification 801.

Description. The life preserver shall be a commercial airline, heat sealed design that conforms to the requirements of paragraph 37.123 ("Life Preserver - TSO-13c"), subpart A, part 37 of the Federal Aviation Regulations. The life preserver shall be a reversible vest type of life preserver that will fit adults and children that are over 18 months old. The life preserver shall be fitted with an adjustable waist strap and a water-activated light with two removable water plugs installed in the battery. The life preserver shall have two inflatable chambers that will encircle the neck of the wearer. Each inflatable chamber shall be fitted with a carbon dioxide inflation assembly and an oral inflation assembly. The carbon dioxide inflation assembly shall consist of an inflator and a filled carbon dioxide cylinder. The oral inflation assembly shall consist of a tube and a valve. The complete life preserver shall be placed in a storage container.

FSC 4220

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Characteristics of components. The components of the life preserver shall be as follows:

(a) The two inflators shall be equal to and interchangeable with Roberts 840-AM inflator (manufactured by the Halkey-Roberts Corporation; Paramus, New Jersey).

(b) The two filled carbon dioxide cylinders shall conform to type III of MIL-C-601.

(c) The two oral inflation tubes and the two oral inflation valves shall be equal to Roberts 727-ACU-66, Roberts 6-3/4 inch red urethane oral tube (manufactured by the Halkey-Roberts Corporation; Paramus, New Jersey).

(d) The water-activated light shall be an emergency signal light that is equal to Part No. L-8-1 (manufactured by ACR Electronics, Inc.; Hollywood, Florida).

(e) The storage container shall conform to figure 1.

(f) The adjustable waist strap shall be a 3/4-inch-wide strap, shall be attached to a back strap panel, and shall be fitted with two swivel eye snaps for connection to a single "D" ring that is sewn to the front of the life preserver. The 3/4 inch swivel eye snaps shall be equal to Part No. 435 (manufactured by the North and Judd Manufacturing Company; New Britain, Connecticut). The "D" ring shall be equal to Part No. 452 (manufactured by the North and Judd Manufacturing Company; New Britain, Connecticut).

Performance. The performance of the life preserver shall conform to ATA Specification 801 except that, when the life preserver is inflated with the 32 grams of the carbon dioxide in the two filled carbon dioxide cylinders, the buoyancy shall be not less than 35 pounds.

Donning and operation instructions. Donning and operating instructions shall be pictorially depicted on both sides of the back strap attachment panel. Donning and operating instructions and figures shall be printed on the storage container.

Identification of product. The life preserver and the storage container shall be marked for identification in accordance with the requirements of paragraph 37.123 ("Life Preservers - TSO-13c"), subpart A, part 37 of the Federal Aviation Regulations. The information "Adult/Child" and "Buoyancy 35 Lbs" shall be included in the identification marking.

Configuration control. Unless otherwise directed by the contracting officer, the contractor shall not change the configuration of the life preserver to be delivered to the Government, notwithstanding authorization from the Federal Aviation Administration.

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered conforms to the requirements specified herein and to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and is the same product that is offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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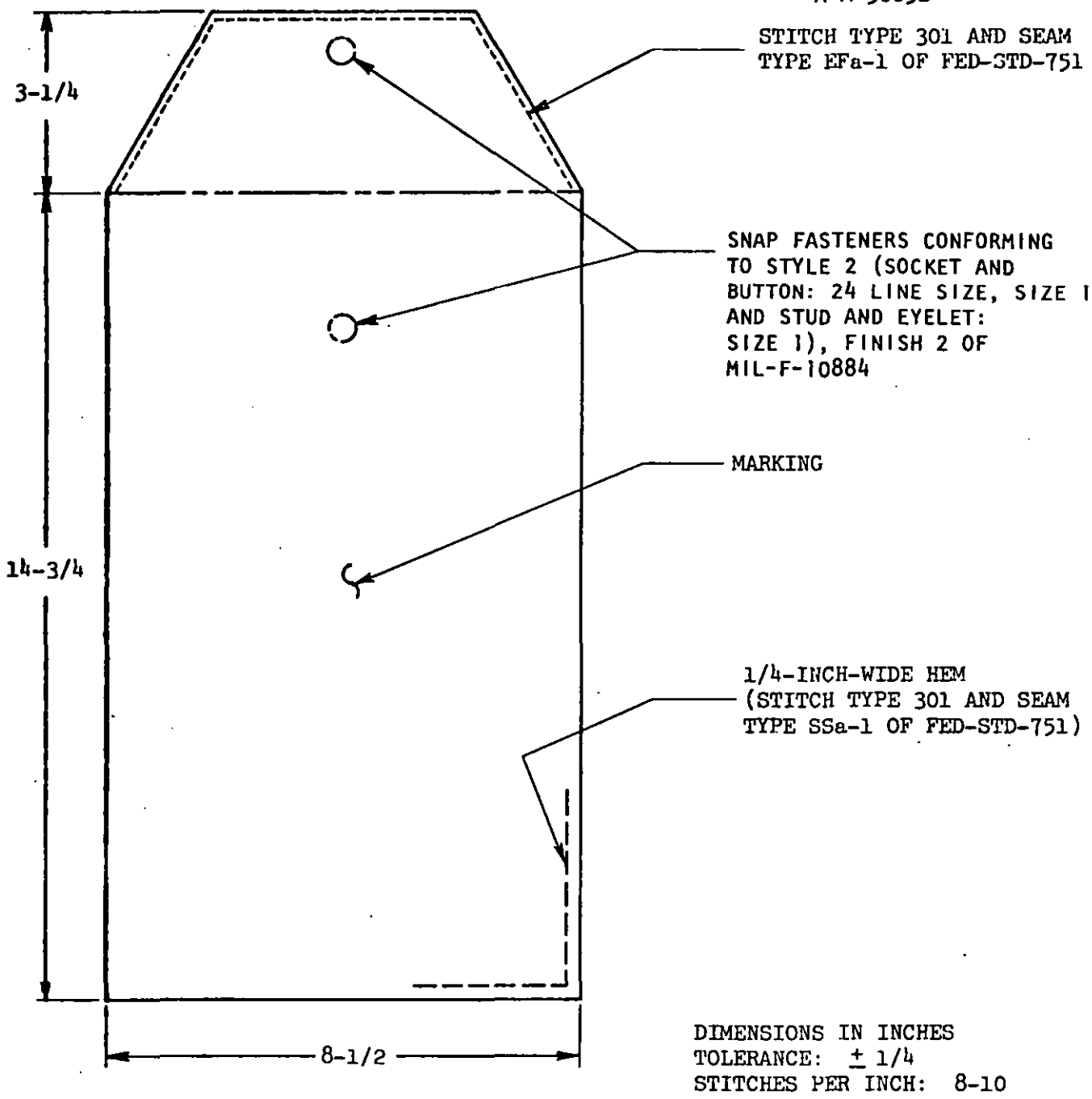


FIGURE 1. Storage container.

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Quality assurance provisions. Each life preserver shall be inspected at the contractor's plant, in accordance with ATA Specification 801 as amended herein and the contractor's quality assurance provisions that are on file at the Engineering and Manufacturing Branch of the Regional Office of the Federal Aviation Administration, to determine compliance with the requirements that are specified herein.

Packaging. The life preserver shall be prepared for delivery in accordance with standard commercial practice. Unit containers, intermediate containers, and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the instructions in the contract or order.

Intended use. The life preserver covered by this commercial item description is intended to be used as emergency flotation gear by an adult or a child while a passenger aboard an aircraft of the Military Airlift Command during flights over water.

Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description

(b) Marking for shipment.

Custodian:
Air Force - 11

Reviewer:
Air Force - 99

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 11

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